

REALISM REDEFINED



MODERN WARFARE 2

Reviewer: Mihir Patkar

Genre: Action, Shooter

Platforms: Windows, Xbox 360, PS3

No of players: Single, Coop, Multi

Developer: Infinity Ward

Publisher: Activision, Square Enix

www.modernwarfare2.com

SYSTEM REQUIREMENT

OS: Windows XP, Vista and 7

Processor: Intel Pentium 4 3.2

GHz or AMD Athlon 64 3200+ processor or better | **RAM:** 1 GB

Graphics: 256 MB NVIDIA GeForce 6600GT, or ATI Radeon 1600XT

HDD: 12 GB free HDD space

Other: Microsoft DirectX(R) 9.0c | 100% DirectX 9.0c compatible sound card | Internet Connection required for activation

A COMPELLING EXPERIENCE

The storyline of Modern Warfare 2 picks up where the prequel left off, recapping the events in a title sequence. There is nothing spectacular in the plot, but it's still an imaginative take on how the next big war could happen: an American mass-murderer in Russia gives Kremlin the opportunity to go for an all-out war.

Over the course of the game, there are several plot twists, intriguing sub-plots and some amazing character-development. The player alternates between the role of US Army Ranger Pvt James Ramirez and an agent in a multinational special ops unit, named Sgt. Gary 'Roach' Sanderson. In your journey, you will meet popular characters from the first game – such as original 'Soap' MacTavish – and encounter interesting new ones like a covert agent who goes by the call-sign 'Ghost'.

The essentials of your objectives in the game are quite clichéd: proving America's innocence, finding the truth behind the entire war and administering justice. Yet, the way Infinity Ward has handled these tried-and-tested elements is what makes MW2 such a special treat.

WHAT? THAT'S NOT REAL!

The lighting and smoke effects in the game have no parallel; from dim light to bright, everything looks just perfect. The snow-based levels even have spots that reflect the light harshly, causing a bit of snow blindness.

It's the attention to detail that grabs you in MW2. A soldier standing for a long time shifts weight from one foot to the other; when sneaking up on someone through bushes, the squad leader ahead of you slowly moves a fallen twig aside; and the blood splatter when you are hit by a bullet looks frighteningly real!

THE AIRPORT MASSACRE

Now, this isn't the first time that a terrorist act has been depicted on screen, or in a video game for that matter. And with games like Carmageddon and Grand Theft Auto, it's also not the first time you are killing civilians and cops.

What is different, though, is that when played from a first-person perspective with this

THE SKOAR

Graphics 9

Audio 10

Mojo 9

Gameplay..... 9

9.5

amount of realism. It's your choice whether to shoot someone or not, and whether to put anyone out of their misery; but the level of realism that the graphics have achieved goes against the game here. It's almost like the Uncanny Valley effect.

SOUNDS GOOD

Infinity Ward went all-out in this department, hiring renowned multi-Oscar-winning composer Hans Zimmer for the game's soundtrack. A fast-paced score while battling multiple enemies in an urban slum makes you instinctively hold the button to sprint; flat, deep notes greet you when you are looking down the scope of a sniper rifle.

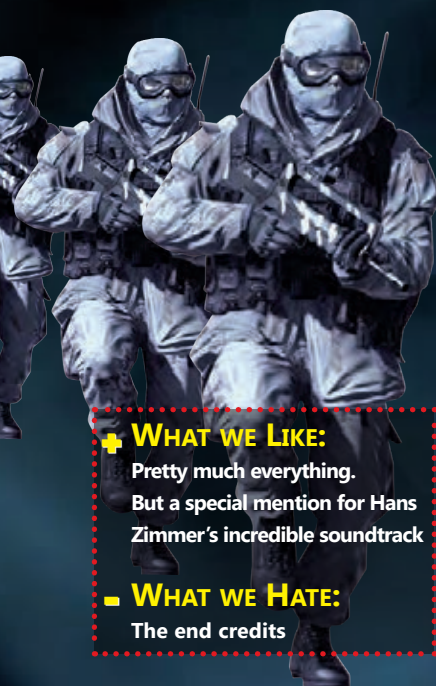
And yet, all of it is so wonderfully gelled into the background that it never dominates the gaming experience, and only adds to the ambience. The sound that comes from the gun you fire is just as important as the feel of the fun, and MW2 knows that.

FEELS JUST RIGHT

The 'feel' of a game is often talked about in reviews. It's an unquantifiable and largely inexplicable term, yet one of the most intuitive aspects that everyone understands easily. This appeal to a base instinct is a remarkable aspect of video games, one that is often experienced with music but not as often with cinema.

Modern Warfare 2 packs a punch. It delivers great highs and sombre lows; it gets you involved and makes you care; it challenges your skills and wit; and overall, it goes beyond being just a game. Play the game for its incredible bridging of cinema and games. Play it for its amazing action sequences and addictive gameplay. Play it for the incredible visuals and the inspired soundtrack.

But beyond all that, Modern Warfare 2 has a solid 'feel', and that alone makes it a game that no one should miss out on.



WHAT WE LIKE:

Pretty much everything. But a special mention for Hans Zimmer's incredible soundtrack

WHAT WE HATE:

The end credits